

either. To understand how to protect against these vulnerabilities, you need to recognise them.

The best way to cut off a social engineering attack is to remove the social element. Keep a password that is disconnected from any personal information of yours.

Of course, that alone is not enough, a password such as “password” might have nothing to do with your personal information, yet it is one that is trivially easy to crack, being a dictionary word.

The goals when creating a secure password should be to create a password which:

- Is long (at least 8 characters, 12 or more recommended)
- Does not use a dictionary word
- Is mixed-case
- Contains at least one digit
- Contains at least one non-alphanumeric character

While all this will create a password that is difficult to crack, it will also make it difficult to remember. There is no point to choosing a very secure password if in the end it is too difficult to remember, and requires you to write it down and keep it in your desk drawer. It is hard to say what is the lesson here, whether you should memorise your password better, or choose an easier to remember, but comparatively less secure password.

A good way to have your cake and eat it too is to create a complicated password based on some memory trick. Instead of remembering the password, you could associate it with something easy to remember in itself – no not your personal data! You could go about this both ways, either take a randomly generated password and create a trick to remember it, for example:

`n<7Plc8c` could be memorised as “no less than 7 People like chocol8 cake”

The sentence itself does not make sense, but that might just make it easier to remember! Alternatively, you can take a meaningful phrase and make it into a complicated password.

“When 900 years old you reach, look as good you will not” can become: `w9cYrlgu!` Or “when 9 centuries You reach look as good u not”

This beats any social engineering attack based on your personal information, since that will not be useful in determining the password. While an attacker might be helped by learning of your liking for “Star Wars”